Bihar Engineering University, Patna

B.Tech 5th Semester Examination 2025

Course: B.Tech
Code: 105503

Subject: Formal Language & Automata Theory

Time: 03 Hours
Full Marks: 70

Instructions:-

(i) The marks are indicated in the right-hand margin.
*(ii) There are **NINE** questions in this paper.*
*(iii) Attempt **FIVE** questions in all.*
*(iv) Question No. **1** is compulsory.*

Q.1 ***Choose the correct option / answer the following (Any seven question only):*** **[2 x 7 = 14]**

(a) Which of the following is the smallest unit in the definition of a language?
(i) Grammar
(ii) Alphabet
(iii) String
(iv) Production

(b) A language is a
(i) Set of alphabets
(ii) Set of strings over an alphabet
(iii) Set of grammars
(iv) Set of automata

(c) Which grammar type is the most powerful?
(i) Type-0
(ii) Type-1
(iii) Type-2
(iv) Type-3

(d) Epsilon (ε) transitions are allowed in
(i) DFA only
(ii) Both DFA and NFA
(iii) NFA only
(iv) None

(e) Context-Free Grammars are equivalent to
(i) Finite Automata
(ii) Turing Machines
(iii) Linear Bounded Automata
(iv) Pushdown Automata

(f) Pumping Lemma for CFLs is used to prove a language is
(i) Not Context-Free
(ii) Regular
(iii) Decidable
(iv) Turing recognizable

(g) Which of the following requires context sensitivity?
(i) $a^n b^n$
(ii) $a^n b^n c^n$
(iii) $(a+b)^*$
(iv) a^*

(h) Recursively Enumerable languages are also called
(i) Turing Recognizable
(ii) Turing Decidable
(iii) Regular
(iv) Context-Free

(i) The Halting Problem is
(i) Decidable
(ii) Undecidable
(iii) Context-Free
(iv) Regular

(j) Which of the following is used to prove many undecidability results?
(i) Pumping Lemma
(ii) Rice's Theorem
(iii) Chomsky Normal Form
(iv) Subset Construction

Q.2 (a) Define the terms: Alphabet, Language, Grammar, and Derivation. Explain the relationship between them with suitable examples. **[7]**

(b) Explain Chomsky Hierarchy of languages with examples of each type and their corresponding automata. **[7]**

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Q.3	(a)	Explain the concept of a Finite Automaton. List and describe its main components. Also, differentiate between Deterministic Finite Automaton and Non-deterministic Finite Automaton with suitable examples.	[7]
	(b)	Construct a DFA that accepts all strings over {0,1} containing even number of 0s and odd number of 1s. Also, write its formal 5-tuple definition.	[7]
Q.4	(a)	Convert the regular expression (a + b)abb(a + b) into an equivalent DFA. Show all steps.	[7]
	(b)	Using Pumping Lemma, prove that the language $L = \{0^n1^n \mid n \geq 0\}$ is not regular.	[7]
Q.5	(a)	Explain how ambiguity arises in the grammar $E \rightarrow E + E \mid E * E \mid id \mid (E)$. Remove the ambiguity by rewriting the grammar.	[7]
	(b)	Using Pumping Lemma for CFLs, prove that $L = \{a^nb^nc^n \mid n \geq 0\}$ is not context-free.	[7]
Q.6	(a)	Explain Linear Bounded Automata and its relationship with Context-Sensitive Languages.	[7]
	(b)	Explain the basic model of a Turing Machine with its formal 7-tuple definition.	[7]
Q.7	(a)	Design a Turing Machine that accepts the language $L = \{a^nb^n \mid n \geq 0\}$. Show the transition diagram/table and trace for input aabb.	[7]
	(b)	State and explain the Church-Turing Thesis.	[7]
Q.8	(a)	Explain the concept of Universal Turing Machine. How does it help in proving undecidability?	[7]
	(b)	Discuss the power and limitations of Turing Machines. Compare Turing Machines with Pushdown Automata.	[7]
Q.9		Write short note on any two of the following:	[7 x 2 = 14]
	(a)	Pushdown Automata	
	(b)	Rice's theorem	
	(c)	Minimization of finite automata	
	(d)	Closure properties of CFLs	

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